



## THE LONG ROAD AHEAD

**20** jungle warfare schools to be set up in Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand and Orissa. Each given Rs 7 crore.

**Current Schools:** 3

**Annual capacity per school:** 1,200

**Deficit:** 17 schools

**Major Problems:**  
Land acquisition, states not transferring Central funds to police force

### THE TRAINING IS INTENSE AND TOUGH AT THE CTJW COLLEGE IN KANKER

budget and the last entry on the priority list. India's total police budget at Rs 45,000 crore is less than 1 per cent of the GDP. Since 2000-2001, the Home Ministry has been releasing Rs 1,000 crore per year for police modernisation to all states. Nearly a decade later, this money is not being effectively spent on the ground. "Security of the state must be the first charge on the state exchequer. Many states allot only the residue—after providing for other Plan and Non-Plan schemes—to the head of 'Police'," Union Home Minister P. Chidambaram said recently.

The states are simply unable to combat the increasing capabilities of the Maoists and this shows in the unacceptable death ratio of 1:2—two dead policemen for every dead Maoist. Worse, the Reds are now mobilising in *dalams* of 300 fighters like the one which attacked the CRPF jawans at Dantewada.

Andhra Pradesh defeated the Naxal menace through intelligence-based operations where the state intelligence bureau, the district police and the elite Greyhounds worked to-

gether to target the Naxal leadership. But other states are unable to replicate this as they don't invest enough in these three basic pillars. Even the worst Naxal-affected state Chhattisgarh allocate only a fraction of funds required, says a December 2009 Institute for Defence Studies and Analyses research paper by BSF Commandant Om Shankar Jha.

Of the total 162 police training institutions, 57 are run by the Central government and even these are in poor shape. The Home Ministry plans to set up 20 Counter-insurgency and anti-terrorism (CIAT) schools with four centres in the five Naxal-affected states. The states have been given Rs 7 crore for the first batch of eight



**“ We require around 100 acres per school for the obstacle courses and firing ranges.**

**Acquiring this land is proving to be a big problem. ”**

**G.K. PILLAI, UNION HOME SECRETARY**

schools which are to begin in the next few years. This is part of what Home Secretary G.K. Pillai calls the "slow process of converting 30 to 40 per cent of our forces into anti-Naxal operations." But lack of land has emerged as the first roadblock. Similarly, Bihar was sanctioned four schools and a seed capital of Rs 6 crore. Not a single school is off the files. "Even after a ramp-up, it will take at least a decade for the Government to field adequate numbers," says Major-General G.D. Bakshi who recommends mass induction of tribals to drain recruits away from the Maoists.

The Home Ministry has sought assistance from the Army which has so far trained over 39,000 police and paramilitary forces. Two months back, it sent in a dozen of its JCOs and NCOS from its commando and jungle warfare schools to the CTJW. After they clear this course, some of them will be hand-picked to train at the more specialised STF school in Gaya.

While these schools are key to a military response, there is also a need to train young officers to lead their troops. Or the price will be paid in blood.

**with Amitabh Srivastava**